LIVING COST ATLAS

RELOCATION INTELLIGENCE SERIES · 2026

The Complete Cost of Living & Relocation Guide

BALI, INDONESIA

2026 EDITION

Data-Driven Insights for Remote Workers, Expats & Global Professionals

Prepared by **Living Cost Atlas Analytics Division** | Relocation Intelligence Report | 2026

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01. Executive Summary

Bali in 2026 is the most mature nomad destination in Asia and increasingly a victim of that maturity. Canggu and Seminyak have gone from USD 300/month villas in 2015 to USD 1,200-1,800/month 1BRs in 2025, traffic is materially worse, and the infrastructure load is showing -- sewage, waste, and power stability all strain during peak season.

The counter-story is that the island still works. Indonesia's Second-Home Visa and the new B211A-plus extensions make 6-12 month stays legally feasible, fibre is reliably 50-100 Mbps in developed zones, Ngurah Rai airport has added long-haul carriers, and the underlying climate-plus-cost proposition remains genuinely unique: you will not find a peer destination with this combination of tropical lifestyle, established coworking, and sub-Western rents.

Verdict for 2026: BUY for mid-stay (2-6 month) nomads who manage the zone selection carefully (Canggu for scene, Ubud for quiet, Sanur for long-term); CONDITIONAL for full-year residents, who increasingly cite over-tourism and infrastructure fatigue as reasons to rotate off-island.

Estimated Monthly Living Costs -- 2026

Resident Profile	Monthly Estimate (IDR)	Lifestyle Descriptor
Budget Nomad	Rp1 100 -- Rp1 430	Shared housing, local transport, home cooking
Standard Remote Professional	Rp2 150 -- Rp2 795	Private 1BR, coworking, regular dining out
Premium Lifestyle Expat	Rp4 900 -- Rp7 350+	Prime district, premium services

Key Strengths

Strength	Commentary
Remote-Friendly Visa	Indonesia Remote Worker Visa available for remote workers. Minimum income requirement: Rp2 000/month.
Digital Infrastructure	Average WiFi speeds of 80 Mbps. Coworking from Rp150/month.
Safety Profile	Safety index: 75/100. Crime level: Moderate.
Healthcare	Healthcare quality score: 65/100.
English Proficiency	English proficiency: 60/100 -- good for international residents.

Key Risks

Risk Factor	Impact Summary
Cost Trajectory	Inflation rate: 3.2%. Rent volatility index: 6.8/10. Market relatively stable.
Tax Burden	Top personal income tax rate: 35%. Corporate tax: 22%. Capital gains: 10%.
Currency Risk	Currency stability: Medium. Exchange rate fluctuations may impact purchasing power.

Living Cost Atlas Index Score -- Bali 2026

Dimension	Weight	Score	Contribution
Affordability	30%	8.5 / 10	2.55
Infrastructure	20%	6.3 / 10	1.25
Safety	15%	7.5 / 10	1.13
Quality of Life	20%	6.5 / 10	1.30

Dimension	Weight	Score	Contribution
Economic Stability	15%	6.0 / 10	0.90
COMPOSITE	**100%**	--	**7.13 / 10**

7.13/10 (BUY) -- Bali represents solid value for international residents.

02. Quick Fact Sheet

Parameter	Value / Estimate	Context
Country	Indonesia	Asia
Currency	IDR (Rp)	Stability: Medium
Rent -- 1BR City Centre	Rp1 500 / month	Varies by district
Rent -- 1BR Outside Centre	Rp900 / month	Commuter accessible
Coworking (Hot Desk)	Rp150 / month	Available citywide
Internet Speed (avg.)	80 Mbps	
Safety Index	75 / 100	Crime: Moderate
Visa	Indonesia Remote Worker Visa	Remote-worker friendly
Visa Processing	30 days	Stay: 12 months
Min. Income Req.	Rp2 000/month	For visa qualification
Top Income Tax	35%	Personal income
Corporate Tax	22%	
Inflation Rate	3.2%	Annual
Public Transport	55 / 100	
Healthcare Quality	65 / 100	
English Proficiency	60 / 100	
Airport Connectivity	70 / 100	
Nomad Score	63 / 100	LCA composite

03. Detailed Cost Breakdown

Itemized monthly cost estimates across major expenditure categories for international residents in Bali. All figures in IDR and reflect Q1 2026 estimates.

Housing

Accommodation Type	Monthly Cost (Rp)	Notes
Studio / 1BR -- City Centre	Rp1 500	Average; varies by district
Studio / 1BR -- Outside Centre	Rp900	Commuter areas
2BR -- City Centre	Rp2 250	Estimated from 1BR rate
2BR -- Outside Centre	Rp1 350	Family-suitable
Shared Room / Coliving	Rp450	Budget option
Short-term (Airbnb-style)	Rp2 700	Monthly rate; higher daily

Food & Dining

Category	Daily Cost (Rp)	Monthly Estimate
Budget (cooking at home)	Rp5	Rp150
Standard (mix of cooking & dining)	Rp15	Rp450
Premium (frequent dining out)	Rp50	Rp1 500

Bali's food split is stark: warungs (local eateries) deliver a nasi campur for IDR 25-40k (USD 1.60-2.50), while the Canggu/Seminyak cafe circuit pushes brunch plates to IDR 120-180k (USD 8-12) -- higher per-plate than much of Bangkok. Groceries at Pepito, Bintang, and Canggu Deli are expensive for imported goods; local wet markets give a dramatic discount for tropical fruit and vegetables. Home cooking is rare -- most long-stay nomads eat out three meals a day.

Transport & Connectivity

Item	Monthly Cost (Rp)
Public Transport Pass	Rp50
Coworking (Hot Desk)	Rp150
Internet (Home)	Rp20
Mobile Plan	Rp13

04. Monthly Budget Scenarios

Three archetypal resident profiles for Bali 2026.

Profile 1 -- Budget Nomad

Expense	Amount (Rp)
Accommodation (shared/suburb)	Rp900
Food (home cooking)	Rp150
Transport	Rp50
Internet + Mobile	Rp25
Entertainment	Rp40
TOTAL	**Rp1 100 -- Rp1 430**

Profile 2 -- Standard Remote Professional

Expense	Amount (Rp)
Accommodation (1BR centre)	Rp1 500
Food (mixed)	Rp450
Transport	Rp50
Coworking	Rp150
Internet + Mobile	Rp25
Entertainment + Dining	Rp100
TOTAL	**Rp2 150 -- Rp2 795**

Profile 3 -- Premium Lifestyle Expat

Expense	Amount (Rp)
Accommodation (premium 2BR)	Rp3 000
Food (premium)	Rp1 500
Transport (car + public)	Rp100
Coworking (dedicated)	Rp300
Healthcare + Insurance	Rp225
Entertainment + Travel	Rp200
TOTAL	**Rp4 900 -- Rp7 350+**

05. Neighborhood Analysis

Five neighborhood profiles for Bali evaluating rental economics, lifestyle character, and demographic fit.

Canggu

District Type: Nomad Capital | Est. 1BR Rent: Rp1 620 -- Rp2 070/month

The default 2020s nomad hub: Dojo, Outpost, and Tropical Nomad anchor a beach-and-coworking strip that's now closer to Silicon-Valley-on-the-beach than local Bali.

Best For -- Digital nomads and solo remote workers prioritising community over quiet.

Ubud

District Type: Inland + Wellness | Est. 1BR Rent: Rp1 283 -- Rp1 639/month

Rice-paddy interior; yoga, plant-medicine, and long-stay wellness culture. Slower pace, cooler nights, no beach.

Best For -- Longer-stay remote workers and those prioritising nature and wellness over surf.

Seminyak

District Type: Polished + Tourist-Heavy | Est. 1BR Rent: Rp1 823 -- Rp2 329/month

Beach clubs, boutique retail, and the priciest villa stock on the west coast; more holiday-rental-feel than day-to-day nomad.

Best For -- Higher-income residents and couples who want Bali with upscale infrastructure.

Uluwatu (Bukit)

District Type: Surf + Cliff | Est. 1BR Rent: Rp1 485 -- Rp1 898/month

Clifftop Bukit peninsula with world-class surf breaks and increasingly polished cafe/coworking build-out over 2022-2025.

Best For -- Surfers and quieter-living remote workers who still want scene.

Sanur

District Type: Family + Quieter | Est. 1BR Rent: Rp1 080 -- Rp1 380/month

The east-coast original-expat zone: calm water, flat beach, established community, and Bali's designated Digital Nomad development zone.

Best For -- Families, long-stay retirees, and those who have already been through Canggu.

06. Work Infrastructure & Digital Readiness

Dimension	Score	Assessment
Internet Speed	80 Mbps	Good -- adequate for remote work
Coworking Ecosystem	Rp150/mo	Affordable coworking market
Public Transport	55/100	Car may be needed
English Proficiency	60/100	Good -- functional for daily life
Airport Connectivity	70/100	Good connections

Commentary. Bali's digital infrastructure positions it well for remote workers. Learning basic local language phrases is recommended.

07. Safety & Quality of Life

Dimension	Score	Notes
Safety Index	75/100	Crime level: Moderate
Healthcare Quality	65/100	Public + private options
Public Transport	55/100	Daily commute viability
English Proficiency	60/100	Ease of integration
Airport Access	70/100	Travel connectivity
Nomad Score	63/100	Overall remote-worker suitability

Seven-Dimension Lived Quality Scorecard

Dimension	Score	Notes
Climate	7.5/10	Tropical: dry season (Apr-Oct) excellent, rainy season (Nov-Mar) humid with afternoon downpours. No winter; no AC-required inland highlands (Ubud).
Walkability	3.5/10	Bali is a scooter island. Canggu/Ubud cores are walkable in zones; between zones, private transport is mandatory. Bike lanes are essentially absent.
Healthcare	5.5/10	BIMC, Siloam, and Kasih Ibu cover routine primary/urgent care competently. Complex cardiac, oncology, or neurosurgery realistically means Singapore/KL evacuation.
Safety (Lived)	7.5/10	Violent crime is low; the real risk vector is scooter accidents (#1 medical issue for visiting nomads). Petty theft and scams present but manageable.
Culture & Arts	8.5/10	Deep Balinese Hindu ceremony integrated into daily life; temple festivals, gamelan, traditional dance. Rice-terrace and coastal-craft traditions remain alive.
Air Quality	7/10	Generally clean; crop-burning and volcanic activity occasionally push AQI into 100-150 range. Canggu street-level traffic fumes are the most common issue.
Green Space	9/10	Rice paddies, jungle, beaches, and Mount Batur all within 90 minutes of Canggu. Near-unmatched natural-environment access at the price point.

Commentary. Bali scores 75/100 on safety, placing it in the safe-to-moderate range. Healthcare at 65/100 may require private insurance for full coverage.

08. City Comparison -- Bali vs. Peer Cities

Bali benchmarked against regionally appropriate peers. Rent differentials are expressed as percentage relative to Bali.

- **Chiang Mai** -- The other Asian-original nomad hub; cheaper, drier, no beach.
- **Ho Chi Minh City** -- Bigger-city peer with better infrastructure, worse weather.
- **Bangkok** -- Regional metropolitan hub most Bali nomads commute through.
- **Kuala Lumpur** -- MM2H-visa capital of SE-Asia for longer stays.

City	1BR Rent	vs. Bali	Safety	Nomad Score
Bali (baseline)	Rp1 500	--	75/100	63/100
Chiang Mai	1 200	-20%	85/100	67/100
Ho Chi Minh City	1 200	-20%	68/100	51/100
Bangkok	1 800	+20%	70/100	73/100
Kuala Lumpur	RM1 650	+10%	72/100	74/100

Commentary. Among peer cities, Bali offers competitive value. Chiang Mai provides the closest comparison in lifestyle and cost profile.

09. Pros & Cons Summary

Strengths

Strength	Detail
Nomad Community Density	Largest concentration of remote workers in Asia; deepest meetup/coliving/coworking mesh.
Tropical Climate	Year-round 25-32C; no winter wardrobe required.
Second-Home / DNV Visa	Genuine 5-10 year legal long-stay pathway with foreign-income tax exemption.
Cost of Living (outside Canggu)	Ubud, Sanur, Amed deliver strong value vs any Western peer.
Wellness Infrastructure	World-class yoga, surf, and wellness offering -- unmatched at this price point.
Villa Housing Culture	Private villa with pool at USD 800-1,800/month (Ubud/Sanur/Uluwatu) is genuinely not matched anywhere else at the price.
Coworking Depth	Dojo, Outpost, Tropical Nomad (Canggu), Hubud (Ubud), and 10+ smaller spaces -- community-focused, not just desks.
Short-Flight Escapes	Singapore (2.5h), KL (3h), Bangkok (4h), and domestic Indonesian islands for weekend rotation.

Limitations

Limitation	Detail
Scooter Injury Rate	Single most common medical issue for visiting nomads; insurance non-negotiable.
Over-Tourism in Canggu/Seminyak	Traffic, waste, and infrastructure strain are visibly worsening year-on-year.
Long-Haul Flight Cost	USD/EUR 800-1500 to most Western home bases; friction for visits home.
Limited Complex Healthcare	Serious procedures usually mean evacuation to Singapore or KL.
Power + Internet Reliability	Rolling outages and fibre disruptions occur; a 4G backup and UPS are standard kit.
Plastic + Water Pollution	Monsoon pushes plastic onto west-coast beaches (Dec-Feb); water quality varies sharply by zone.
Regulatory Volatility	Permit crackdowns, moped-licence enforcement drives, and tourist-visible business restrictions all surface intermittently.
Lifestyle Fatigue Past 12 Months	Scene-saturation, community rotation, and infrastructure erosion drive most full-year residents off-island by year 2.

10. Who Should Move to Bali?

Bali operates on "jam karet" (rubber time) for most service interactions, with deep Balinese Hindu ceremony integrated into daily life -- expect road closures for processions and neighbourhood ceremonies that pause normal rhythms. The expat community is vast but bubbled in Canggu/Ubud/Uluwatu; respectful integration with local Balinese and Indonesian communities is a slower, longer project. Indonesian (Bahasa) basics go a long way; Balinese is a separate language reserved for ceremony and elders.

Solo Remote Workers

CONDITIONAL

Great 3-6 month base; quality of life erodes past year one for most. Canggu/Ubud coworking is mature, but expect lifestyle fatigue and scene saturation.

Digital Nomads (3-6 months)

RECOMMENDED

Still the highest-density nomad community in Asia. E33G (Digital Nomad Visa, tax-free for foreign-source income) makes 12-month stays viable for qualifying applicants.

Relocating Families

CONDITIONAL

Sanur and Ubud work better than Canggu for families. International schools (Green School, Sanur Independent) are excellent but fees mid-tier international.

Retirees

RECOMMENDED

Second Home Visa (5-10 year) with USD ~130k deposit requirement suits well-capitalised retirees. Healthcare is adequate for primary care, Singapore/KL for serious cases.

Entrepreneurs

CONDITIONAL

Excellent for content/creator/lifestyle businesses; weaker for anyone needing local legal entities or banking. PT PMA setup is doable but requires local counsel.

11. Risk Factors & Economic Outlook

Risk Vector	Level	Assessment
Visa Overstay / Enforcement	MODERATE	Indonesia has periodically tightened enforcement on visa misuse (B211 used for de-facto work). The new DNV (Second Home / E33G) is the safer long-stay path.
Traffic + Infrastructure Strain	HIGH	Canggu-Seminyak rush hour can hit 90+ minutes for 10km. Scooter is default transport and the single largest safety/injury vector on the island.
Scooter Accidents	HIGH	Scooter injuries are the #1 medical issue for visiting nomads. BPJS + a robust international policy (evacuation cover included) are non-negotiable.
Rainy Season (Nov-Mar)	LOW	Significant rainfall and humidity; some coworking/outdoor setups are limited. Not a deal-breaker but schedule accordingly.
Tourism Tax + Regulation Drift	MODERATE	Bali Tourism Tax (IDR 150k) introduced 2024; further restrictions on nomad-visible business (signage, illegal villas, moped licences) are likely in 2026-2027.
Healthcare Complexity	MODERATE	BIMC and Siloam cover routine care; anything complex (cancer, cardiac surgery) realistically means medical evacuation to Singapore or KL. International insurance with evac cover is essential.

12. Living Cost Atlas Index Methodology

The LCA Index is a composite scoring framework providing standardized relocation intelligence across global cities.

Dimension	Weight	Data Sources
Affordability	30%	Rent indices, grocery costs, transport, coworking pricing
Infrastructure	20%	Internet speed, public transport, healthcare, airport connectivity
Safety	15%	Crime indices, political stability, emergency services
Quality of Life	20%	Climate, walkability, culture, healthcare access
Economic Stability	15%	Currency stability, inflation, GDP growth, policy environment

LCA Index = (Affordability x 0.30) + (Infrastructure x 0.20) + (Safety x 0.15) + (Quality of Life x 0.20) + (Economic Stability x 0.15)

Score Range	Classification	Guidance
8.0 -- 10.0	STRONG BUY	Top-tier destination; plan actively
6.5 -- 7.99	BUY	Solid destination; proceed with planning
5.0 -- 6.49	HOLD	Selective appeal; detailed research required
Below 5.0	CAUTION	Significant trade-offs; specialist advice recommended

13. Final Verdict

Living Cost Atlas's assessment of Bali as a 2026 relocation destination.

LCA Index	Classification	Recommendation
7.13 out of 10.0	BUY	PROCEED WITH PLANNING

Bali scores 7.13/10 on the Living Cost Atlas Index, classified as BUY. Bali offers solid fundamentals for international residents.

Verdict for Digital Nomads

Bali in 2026 remains the highest-density nomad base in Asia, but it works best as a 2-6 month rotation rather than a year-round base. Canggu for scene, Ubud for quiet, Sanur for family/long-stay, Uluwatu for surf. Standard budget lands USD 1,800-2,800/month in Canggu (villa, coworking, eating out), dropping 25-35% in Ubud or Sanur. The DNV (E33G) with its foreign-income tax exemption legitimises long-stay for those who qualify on deposit/income.

Verdict for Families

For families, Sanur and Ubud work markedly better than Canggu. Green School (Ubud) and Sanur Independent are internationally respected; fees are mid-tier international (USD 10-20k/child). The main friction is medical -- complex conditions require evacuation planning, and a serious international policy with medevac is essential. Bali works best for families with 6 months to 2 years of timeline, less well for multi-year relocation.

Verdict for Founders & Entrepreneurs

Bali is excellent for content/creator/lifestyle/course-selling businesses with global customers. It is weaker for anyone needing Indonesian legal entities, payment rails, or serious banking infrastructure. PT PMA setup is doable but requires local counsel, and Indonesian banking as a foreigner is non-trivial. Most successful founders on the island run offshore (Singapore, Delaware) entities with Bali as residence, not business base.

CLOSING STATEMENT

Bali in 2026 is the mature Asian nomad capital -- unmatched on lifestyle-cost ratio, pressured on infrastructure and sustainability. BUY for 2-6 month rotations; CONDITIONAL BUY for full-year residents who manage zone selection carefully; CAUTION for anyone who needs serious medical infrastructure or complex local business operations.

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A. Appendix: Getting Set Up -- Your First 30 Days

A practical field handbook for the first month in Bali. Banking, mobile, coworking, essential apps, and a week-by-week bureaucracy timeline -- the real operational sequence that determines whether your relocation stalls or stabilises.

Banking

Provider	Notes
BNI or Permata (KITAS-only)	Local Indonesian accounts require a KITAS (limited-stay permit). BNI Taplus at Sanur or Ubud branches is the most tourist-friendly; minimum IDR 500k deposit.

Provider	Notes
Wise IDR + ATM	Tourist-visa and B211A holders generally stick with Wise IDR balance + Charles Schwab / Revolut ATM cards. Mandiri and BCA ATMs accept major cards; Bank Central Asia is the most reliable.
Jenius (digital, KITAS-only)	BTPN subsidiary, fully-digital neobank, great app, but still requires KITAS to onboard.

Mobile / SIM

Operator	Plan & Price
Telkomsel	Best coverage islandwide including Ubud/Uluwatu. Tourist kartuHalo 30-day 25GB IDR 150k at airport or any counter.
XL Axiata / Smartfren	Cheaper backups: IDR 100k 20GB 30 days. Smartfren strongest in Canggu/Berawa.
Airalo Indonesia eSIM	Best for 48-hour bridge upon landing before you reach a kiosk.

Coworking -- Named Recommendations

Space	Area	Price & Vibe
Dojo Bali	Canggu (Echo Beach)	IDR 3.8M/mo (~USD 240). The original Bali coworking space; pool, strong community events.
Tropical Nomad	Canggu	IDR 3.2M/mo. Quieter alternative to Dojo; better A/C, serious focus culture.
Outpost Ubud	Ubud (Penestanan)	IDR 3.5M/mo. Jungle setting, yoga-adjacent scene, slower vibe than Canggu.

Essential Apps

- Gojek (ride + food + almost everything)
- Grab (backup)
- WhatsApp (essential)
- Tokopedia / Shopee (e-commerce)
- Pluang / Flip (IDR transfers)
- Visit Indonesia (e-visa)

Week-by-Week Timeline

W1 Week 1 -- Arrive with B211A Visit Visa or new Remote Worker Visa (E33G, launched 2024). Telkomsel SIM at DPS airport. Base in Canggu or Ubud guesthouse.

W2 Week 2 -- Villa hunting via agents (Kibarer, Bali Home Immo) or FB groups. 6- or 12-month payment upfront is still standard; negotiate 3-month trial if possible.

W3 Week 3 -- If E33G holder: obtain KITAS via local agent (IDR 8-15M, 2-3 weeks processing). Register at kelurahan (local government) for residence report.

W4 Week 4 -- Open BNI/Permata if KITAS in hand, join Dojo/Tropical Nomad/Outpost, sort scooter rental (IDR 1.5-2M/mo) with international driving permit + helmet + insurance.

B. Appendix: Common Scams & Gotchas

The defensive manual. These are the recurring scams, rent-hustles, and bureaucratic traps that cost new arrivals real money in Bali. Each entry is a known-pattern with the counter-move in one line.

Scam / Gotcha	How to defuse
Scooter rental "scratch" scam	Renter demands IDR 2-5M for pre-existing damage. Film 360-degree video at pickup, never leave the passport -- leave a copy.
ATM card skimming in Kuta/Legian	Indonesian ATM skimmers are still active 2026. Use bank-branch ATMs only (BCA, Mandiri) during business hours.
Bali visa agent overcharging	B211A "6-month" visa via street agents charging USD 600-900 when official is USD 150-250. Use established agencies with public reviews (ChannelOne, Bali Solve).
"Free" driving tour / taxi commission loops	Driver insists on "quick stop" at silver, batik, coffee plantation -- earns commission on your forced purchases. Agree itinerary in writing; refuse detours.
Customs kickbacks at DPS arrival	Occasionally an "import fee" is demanded on laptop or drone. Real fees are published; ask for a formal receipt or request supervisor.
Land-lease fraud via Nominee	Foreigners "buying" land via Indonesian nominee is illegal and unenforceable. Use leasehold (Hak Sewa) via a proper notaris (PPAT) only.

Patterns rotate; treat this as a baseline, not an exhaustive list. When in doubt, walk away.